

Question ID: 84664a7c

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear functions	Easy

Question

The front of a roller-coaster car is at the bottom of a hill and is 15 feet above the ground. If the front of the roller-coaster car rises at a constant rate of 8 feet per second, which of the following equations gives the height h , in feet, of the front of the roller-coaster car s seconds after it starts up the hill?

Answer

A. $h = 8s + 15$

B. $h = 15s + \frac{335}{8}$

C. $h = 8s + \frac{335}{15}$

D. $h = 15s + 8$

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. It's given that the front of the roller-coaster car starts rising when it's 15 feet above the ground. This initial height of 15 feet can be represented by a constant term, 15, in an equation. Each second, the front of the roller-coaster car rises 8 feet, which can be represented by $8s$. Thus, the equation $h = 8s + 15$ gives the height, in feet, of the front of the roller-coaster car s seconds after it starts up the hill.

Choices B and C are incorrect and may result from conceptual errors in creating a linear equation. Choice D is incorrect and may result from switching the rate at which the roller-coaster car rises with its initial height.